DAILY

# Daily World Events Intelligence Summary — 2026-11-05

**DTG** 050730 CST NOV 26

**PERIOD** 2026-11-04 ~0730 CST to 2026-11-05 ~0730 CST

daily · intel · world-events · US-impact · economy · Minnesota-costs · midterms · election-results · Democrats · House · Senate · Alaska · Peltola · Sullivan · Mississippi · Colom · Hyde-Smith · Johnson · Scalise · Jordan · Thune · Schumer · Jeffries · Vance · Hegseth · Crow · Trump · Iran · Ghalibaf · Rezaei · Mojtaba-Khamenei · Oman · Araghchi · Qatar · China · Eurasia-Group · Hormuz · UKMTO · 196-26 · Madinat-ash-Shamal · IRGC · mines · LUCAS · MQ-1 · Treasury-sanctions · Operation-Economic-Outcast · oil · Brent · WTI · Dow · S&P-500 · Nasdaq · ADP · EIA · gold · national-debt · Israel-aid · Netanyahu · Eisenkot · Russia · Ukraine · Brussels-talks · Abu-Dhabi-talks · Melania-Trump · Ryazan · Nova-Poshta · Kyiv-blackouts · Houthis · Medina · King-Khalid-airport · Taiz · ICRC · Minnesota · MN-1 · Jake-Johnson · Finstad · recount · Omar

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DAILY WORLD EVENTS INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
DTG: 050730 CST NOV 26 (America/Chicago)
PERIOD COVERED: ~0730 hours CST 04 NOV 26 through ~0730 hours CST 05 NOV 26 (CT)
PREPARED FOR: Kyle Sibley
CLASSIFICATION: UNCLASSIFIED // FOR INFORMATIONAL USE

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Democrats have won at least 240 House seats and 54 Senate seats, with Alaska and Mississippi still uncalled and both led narrowly by Democrats; CBS projects a final House of 251 to 268 Democratic seats. Speaker Mike Johnson will not run for minority leader, and Steve Scalise and Jim Jordan are running. Vice President Vance wrote “The reason we lost is the war,” and Trump agreed it was “largely true” but said he would do it again; CBS reports Trump has asked advisers whether Hegseth should stay, while he publicly said Hegseth is “doing a very good job.” Schumer said the Iran war “must end” and pointed to the power of the purse. Iran’s leaders cast the vote as a US defeat, and a statement attributed to Mojtaba Khamenei warned against expecting change. At sea, UKMTO 196-26 reports a tanker hit by two projectiles about 50 nautical miles north of Qatar, deeper in the Gulf than recent attacks, while the IRGC claims more tankers burning after hitting mines. Markets read the result as lowering war risk: the Dow rose 1,569 points (3.03%), Brent fell 8.7% to $94.62, and gold gained about 3.5%. Oil bounced about 1.6% early Thursday. Trump’s 03 NOV statement that $4 billion a year in US military aid to Israel ends at year-end is also carried here. MN-1 is headed toward a possible recount, with Johnson ahead by 323 votes. MN regular is $3.9977 and diesel $6.1183 (AAA 05 NOV); gold is about $4,116; debt is $40.547T (03 NOV).

## ITEM 1: Election Aftermath — Democrats at 240+ House and 54 Senate Seats; Alaska and Mississippi Uncalled; Johnson Steps Aside as GOP Leader; Schumer Vows “Legislative Razor Wire”

**WHAT / WHERE / WHEN**

As of 0900 GMT (0300 CST) 05 NOV, Democrats had won at least 240 House seats and 54 Senate seats to Republicans’ 147 and 44, with 48 House races and the Alaska and Mississippi Senate races uncalled (Al Jazeera; the Guardian’s results page showed the same totals with 387 of 435 House races called). CBS News projects Democrats will hold 251 to 268 House seats; Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries said he expects at least 255 and that no one in his caucus has raised impeaching Trump (CBS). In Mississippi, Democrat Scott Colom led Sen. Cindy Hyde-Smith by 1,138 votes with about 3,600 mail ballots and an unknown number of affidavit ballots left; counties must certify by 13 NOV (AP via Al Jazeera, citing Secretary of State Michael Watson). In Alaska, Democrat Mary Peltola led Sen. Dan Sullivan by 637 votes with nearly a quarter of votes uncounted; ranked-choice results are due 18 NOV, and a federal judge dismissed DOJ’s suit to block certification on 01 NOV, which DOJ has said it will appeal (AP via Al Jazeera). Speaker Mike Johnson told staff he will not run for minority leader; Majority Leader Steve Scalise and Rep. Jim Jordan are running (Fox News; CBS). TheBlaze reported Sen. John Thune will seek another term as Senate GOP leader. Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer vowed to wrap Trump in “legislative razor wire” (CBS);

Kansas Senator-elect Adam Hamilton told CBS, “I do not want to spend the next two years in trials.” The University of Florida Election Lab estimated 122.7 million ballots and 48.8% turnout, the second-highest midterm rate in more than a century (Al Jazeera).

**US IMPACT ASSESSMENT**

Democrats will start in January with at least 54 Senate seats and a large House majority. Alaska and Mississippi decide whether the Senate majority reaches 56, which narrows how many Republican votes Democrats need to break filibusters. Leadership fights on the GOP side and Democratic oversight planning will shape the lame-duck session through year-end.

**SOURCE SYNOPSIS**

Al Jazeera (05 NOV, two articles, read directly; Mississippi/Alaska drawn from AP); Guardian results page (05 NOV, 0233 CST, search excerpt); CBS News live updates (05 NOV, search excerpts); Fox News X posts (04 NOV); TheBlaze X post (05 NOV).

**MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)**

Fox News led with the Johnson, Scalise, and Jordan leadership shuffle and Jeffries’ “We don’t work for JD Vance” line. TheBlaze highlighted Senator-elect Talarico saying he would vote to end the filibuster and Ron DeSantis attacking Senate Republicans for not codifying Trump’s immigration orders. Tim Pool posted “Nick Fuentes is the future of the GOP” and said “MAGA is OVER”; Timcast News cited a 43-point swing among young white men without college degrees (figure not verified). Steven Crowder warned “woke 2.0 is coming with a vengeance.”

**MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)**

Al Jazeera described a “Democratic wave” and quoted Jeffries’ “American tsunami”; CBS framed Democrats laying out how to “wield power” while the GOP grapples with “stunning losses.”

**CONFIDENCE**

HIGH on called-seat counts, uncalled races, and Johnson’s decision (multiple outlets). MODERATE on final House totals (projections differ: 251–268 CBS; 255 Jeffries).

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## ITEM 2: Who Lost It — Vance Says “The Reason We Lost Is the War”; Trump Says “Largely True” but Would Do It Again; Hegseth’s Future Questioned

**WHAT / WHERE / WHEN**

On 04 NOV Vice President JD Vance posted on X: “The reason we lost is the war. The president himself said so last night… If you’d like to argue it was worth it, that losing the Senate for the next 6 years was worth it, then do so.” He listed four reasons Trump voters backed Democrats: ending the Iran war, cost of living and inflation, putting America first, and changing the US relationship with Israel (CBS; Fox News). Trump told reporters it was “largely true because it drove the gasoline up a little bit short term… if I had it to do again, I’d have to do it again,” and “as far as that war is concerned, I would have done nothing different” (CBS; Fox News). He told the Wall Street Journal, “I did the right thing. I would have done it again” (CBS). CBS’s Jennifer Jacobs reported, citing multiple sources, that Trump has been asking advisers whether Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth should stay, and that some aides expect blame to fall on CENTCOM’s Adm. Brad Cooper and Joint Chiefs Chairman Gen. Dan Caine; other sources said no decision has been made. Asked publicly whether he would replace Hegseth, Trump said, “No, I think he’s doing a very good job”; asked about impeachment, he said “Not even a little bit” (Daily Wire clips). Rep. Jason Crow (D-Colo.) said “The war has got to end,” that Democrats will use war-powers votes and appropriations, and that Hegseth “needs to go” (CBS).

**US IMPACT ASSESSMENT**

The vice president publicly tying the defeat to the war, with the president partly agreeing, weakens the political footing for a new Iran campaign and raises the odds of a Pentagon shake-up. A Hegseth departure or an impeachment push would land in the new Congress.

**SOURCE SYNOPSIS**

CBS News live updates (04–05 NOV, read directly); Fox News X posts (04 NOV); Daily Wire X clips (04 NOV); Fox News and SAN on Hegseth (headlines/summaries).

**MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)**

Fox News ran Vance’s post as “BREAKING” and Trump’s “would have done nothing different.” Daily Wire’s Matt Walsh said the defeat came from “the bad economy” and called Trump’s ballroom event “baffling”; he also wrote that Democrats “will get into office and immediately

start investigating Trump" and predicted impeachments. Glenn Beck hosted Steve Deace saying GOP "credibility as a party is broken."

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) CBS framed Vance's post as a possible 2028 contender breaking with the war; NPR said both Trump and Vance acknowledged the war's role.

CONFIDENCE HIGH on Vance's and Trump's quotes (on record, multiple outlets). MODERATE on the Hegseth deliberations (anonymous sources; Trump's public denial).

## ITEM 3: Iran — Tehran Calls the Vote a US Defeat; Khamenei Statement Warns Against Expecting Change; Oman and Iran Discuss Joint Hormuz Mechanism; Trump "Locked and Loaded" but "No Reason" Yet

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN Iran's chief negotiator and parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf posted on 04 NOV, "Americans said NO TO WAR, and we endorse this message," adding that if the US government ignores that will, "it will learn our NO comes with a Nightmare" (CBS). Supreme National Security Council secretary Mohsen Rezaei posted that Iran handed Trump "a POLITICAL DEFEAT in Washington" and "Anyone who takes on Iran will pay the price — from the battlefield to their own doorstep" (CBS). A statement on Mojtaba Khamenei's website said anyone hoping US behavior "might change through partisan or factional shifts" is "seriously mistaken" and that if attacks are repeated "the war's scope will become much wider" (CBS/AFP; he has not appeared publicly since being named). Trump told the Financial Times "we're locked and loaded if we need to go, but there may be no reason for it" (CBS). On 05 NOV Oman said its foreign minister and Iran's Abbas Araghchi discussed "joint technical mechanisms" for Hormuz traffic "that would end the state of war" (Omani Foreign Ministry via CBS). China said avoiding renewed hostilities is its "top priority" and will send its Middle East envoy to Iran, Oman, and Saudi Arabia later this month (CBS/AFP). Eurasia Group cut its odds of renewed US strikes to 60% from 65% and of a deal to 10% from 20%, and raised a continued standoff to 30% (Reuters via CNBC). CBS reported that Vance reportedly reached out to Rezaei last week about ceasefire conditions. No public result was found from the Qatari 36-hour feedback window reported on 03 NOV.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT Iran is reading the election as leverage and is unlikely to soften its seven conditions soon. The Oman track points to a possible joint traffic mechanism, which the US has opposed in the past. With strike odds still put above even by one consultancy, the risk of renewed fighting and an oil spike has not gone away.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS CBS News live updates (04–05 NOV, read directly, includes AFP material); Reuters via CNBC (05 NOV, read directly); NPR (05 NOV, summary).

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) No right-leaning coverage of Iran's statements or the Oman track was found. Matt Walsh argued Iran never had the power to destroy the US and that the bigger threat is "the communists" at home.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) CBS led with "Iran says U.S. election results show Americans reject war"; NPR said Iran remains "wary of new U.S. attacks."

CONFIDENCE HIGH on on-record statements. MODERATE on the Vance–Rezaei contact (reported secondhand). LOW on any deal timeline.

## ITEM 4: Gulf Shipping — UKMTO 196-26: Tanker Hit by Two Projectiles 50 nm North of Qatar; IRGC Claims More Mine Strikes and Captured US Drones; Treasury Sanctions India-Based Fraud Network

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN UKMTO Warning 196-26 (source verified) reports that at 2320 UTC 04 NOV (1720 CST) a tanker was struck by two unidentified projectiles about 50 nautical miles north of Madinat ash Shamal, Qatar; crew status, damage, and environmental impact were unconfirmed (UKMTO PDF; Iran International; AP). The vessel and attacker were not named. The IRGC claimed on 04 NOV that four "non-compliant" tankers were destroyed by mines south of the strait and two vessels halted; overnight it claimed two more tankers and a tugboat caught fire, and

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| | early 05 NOV that another tanker that had switched off its tracking hit a mine east of the strait (Fars and IRNA via CBS; Al Jazeera). Fars also claimed the IRGC took control of two US LUCAS attack drones intact, and on 04 NOV the IRGC claimed it shot down a US MQ-1 over Qeshm, its "15th"; US officials told CBS in September that at least two MQ-1s had been downed. None of these IRGC claims has been confirmed. On 04 NOV Treasury sanctioned a "vast criminal network" run by Indian nationals Suniel Kumar Sharma and Jaspreet Preeti Shahid that it says helped Iran's shadow fleet sail under false flags; Treasury Secretary Bessent said, "under Operation Economic Outcast, you are either with us or against us" (CBS). Analysts say Gulf crude shipments through the strait have recovered close to pre-war levels at higher cost (Reuters via CNBC). |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | An attack north of Qatar, well inside the Gulf, would widen the threatened area beyond the strait and the Omani coast and could raise insurance costs for Qatari and Kuwaiti routes. The IRGC claims, even unverified, signal Iran is still enforcing its "authorized route" rule while talks continue. |
| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | UKMTO 196-26 PDF (05 NOV, search excerpt); Iran International (05 NOV); AP (05 NOV, summary); CBS News live updates (read directly); Al Jazeera live blog (05 NOV, read directly); Reuters via CNBC (05 NOV). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | No right-leaning coverage of these ship attacks or the sanctions was found. |
| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | CBS and AP paired the attacks with the diplomatic push, noting ships are hit "despite U.S. assertions that the strait is now open." |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH on UKMTO text and Treasury action. LOW on IRGC mine, fire, and drone claims (Iranian sources only, no vessel names). |

## ITEM 5: Economy and Markets — Dow's Best Day Since April 2025; Oil Plunges 8% Then Bounces; Gold Up 3.5%; ADP +86,000; Jobs Report Friday

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| WHAT / WHERE / WHEN | On 04 NOV the Dow rose 1,569.40 points (3.03%) to 53,356.12, its best day since 09 APR 2025; the S&P 500 gained 1.58% to 7,688.62 and the Nasdaq 1.44% to 25,736.51 (CNBC). WTI fell 8.3% to settle at $88.12 and Brent 8.7% to $94.62, their lowest since 31 AUG, after Vance blamed the war for the losses (CNBC); Reuters said Brent was down nearly 20% for the week so far. Reuters also reported energy stocks down 4.8%, defense and data-center shares lower, the dollar at its lowest since 30 SEP, Treasury yields down 3 to 7 basis points, bitcoin above $80,000, and gold up 3.5% back above $4,000, its best day since 19 AUG. Early 05 NOV Brent was up $1.53 (1.6%) at $96.15 and WTI up 52 cents at $88.64 (Reuters via CNBC); Citi warned the White House could still escalate using executive powers, and JPMorgan estimated the oil market returned to a surplus of 1.4 million barrels per day in October. ADP said private employers added 86,000 jobs in October, slightly above expectations (CNBC headline). EIA said US crude, gasoline, and distillate stocks all fell last week as demand hit a one-year high (Reuters via CNBC); a search summary put the crude draw at 0.9 million barrels to 409.8 million. Stock futures were mixed early Thursday as the rally cooled (Yahoo Finance and TipRanks headlines). The October jobs report is due Friday, 06 NOV. |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | Falling crude should pull gasoline and diesel lower over the next one to two weeks; Minnesota regular is already below $4 (snapshot). Markets are pricing an end to the war, so any renewed strikes would hit quickly; Eurasia Group projects $110 to $125 Brent on escalation. |
| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | CNBC markets and oil stories (04–05 NOV, read directly or via search excerpt); Reuters "Trading Day" via Investing.com (04 NOV, excerpt); Washington Post (04 NOV, excerpt); CNBC ADP story (headline); OilPrice.com/EIA (search summary). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | TheBlaze posted "Stock market shows largest gains of the year after midterm massacre," noting all three indices gained and oil dropped. |

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| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | CNBC and the Washington Post said a decisive result removed uncertainty, and that Democrats will be a check on tariffs and the war "that's boosted inflation." |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH on closing levels and oil settlements. MODERATE on the EIA crude figure (search summary) and Thursday futures (headlines only). |

## ITEM 6: Israel Aid — Trump Says $4 Billion in Annual US Military Aid Ends at Year-End

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| WHAT / WHERE / WHEN | On Election Day, 03 NOV, Trump said of US military aid to Israel, "We were giving them $4 billion. We are. But it gets cut off at the end of the year," saying Israel doesn't "need it"; Fox News reported Israel can still buy US weapons (CNN; Fox News; Reuters; AP; Washington Post headlines/summaries). Search summaries of Reuters and i24 coverage note the current agreement provides $3.8 billion a year through 2028 and that Congress has already approved funding through September 2027, so an immediate cutoff is not straightforward. Netanyahu's office did not respond to Trump's claim of an agreement, and opposition figure Gadi Eisenkot called Netanyahu "a real danger" (JTA; Israel.com). Vance listed changing the relationship with Israel among voters' four demands (Item 2). This was not covered in the 04 NOV report and is added here. |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | Ending the aid package would be a major shift in US policy, but Congress controls the money, and the incoming Democratic majority is split on Israel. Expect fights over the FY2027 defense bill and the 2028 agreement's future. |
| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | CNN, Fox News, Reuters, AP, Washington Post (03 NOV, headlines and search summaries; full articles not read); JTA and Israel.com (summaries). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | Fox News framed it as Israel no longer receiving aid but still able to buy weapons. Vance's post put Israel policy among the GOP's problems with its own voters. |
| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | Reuters and i24 asked whether Trump can actually do it given the existing agreement and appropriations. |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH that Trump made the statement (multiple outlets). LOW on whether aid actually stops on that timeline. |

## ITEM 7: Russia–Ukraine — Brussels Reconstruction Talks; Melania Trump Hosts Oleshky Talks; Ukraine Hits Ryazan Refinery; Russia Strikes Logistics and Grid

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| WHAT / WHERE / WHEN | The European Commission hosted talks on Ukraine's postwar reconstruction in Brussels on 04 NOV with the US, Ukraine, France, Germany, Britain, and the World Bank, covering security guarantees and reconstruction funding, as a follow-up to October meetings in Miami (UPI). A search summary says Jared Kushner and envoy Steve Witkoff spoke with Zelenskyy about ending the war. UPI reported First Lady Melania Trump hosts Ukrainian and Russian representatives at the White House on 05 NOV after the Oleshky ceasefire she brokered; trilateral US–Russia–Ukraine talks are set for 10–11 NOV in Abu Dhabi. Overnight, Russia's defense ministry said it struck a Nova Poshta delivery terminal near Kharkiv, a 330-kilovolt substation in Dnipropetrovsk, and a cargo ship it said carried military equipment 52 km southwest of Odesa; Ukraine did not confirm the terminal or ship strikes. Kharkiv's governor said more than 80 drones injured six, and Donetsk's governor said four civilians were killed on 04 NOV. Ryazan's governor said more than 200 Ukrainian drones attacked the region; footage verified by Russian outlet Astra showed a fire at Rosneft's Ryazan refinery (Al Jazeera). Kyiv has had rolling blackouts since mid-October, and some residents have gone days without water (Al Jazeera). A Kyiv Independent headline put Russian attacks over the past day at 9 killed and 19 injured. |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | The US is running three tracks at once (Brussels reconstruction, the White House Oleshky talks, and Abu Dhabi), giving the administration a foreign-policy push after the election loss. Ukraine's refinery strikes add modest pressure to global fuel markets. |

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| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | UPI (04 NOV, read directly); Al Jazeera (05 NOV, read directly); AP and Kyiv Independent (05 NOV, headlines); The Hill (headline). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | No right-leaning Ukraine coverage was found in the monitored feeds. |
| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | AP said the strikes “underscore” the importance of the Brussels talks; Al Jazeera emphasized civilian hardship in Kyiv as winter nears. |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH on the Brussels meeting and the Ryazan fire (verified footage). MODERATE on Russian strike claims (unconfirmed by Ukraine) and the Melania Trump meeting date (single outlet). |

## ITEM 8: Saudi Arabia/Yemen — Houthi Missile Toward Medina Intercepted; Houthis Claim Hit on Riyadh Airport; Red Cross Reaches Taiz

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| WHAT / WHERE / WHEN | On 05 NOV coalition spokesman Turki al-Malki said air defenses intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile launched toward the Medina region (CBS; Al Jazeera). On 04 NOV Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claimed a ballistic missile hit King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, causing “extensive damage,” and urged airlines to avoid Saudi airspace except over Mecca and Medina; Saudi authorities did not comment (CBS). Saree also claimed a Saudi drone shot down over Taiz and strikes on Saudi forces in al-Jawf, a radar near Jizan, and a camp in Najran (unverified). The ICRC delivered four trucks of medical supplies to Taiz on 04 NOV, its first since 23 SEP (CBS/AFP). |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | Missile fire toward Medina and claimed hits on Riyadh’s airport keep Saudi aviation and oil infrastructure at risk; the State Department’s ordered departure from Saudi Arabia remains relevant to US citizens there. |
| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | CBS News live updates (04–05 NOV, read directly); Al Jazeera live blog (05 NOV). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | No right-leaning coverage found. |
| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | CBS noted Saudi Arabia “has been unable to stop” Houthi attacks despite its advantages. |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH on the coalition intercept statement. LOW on Houthi claims of damage. |

## ITEM 9: Minnesota — Jake Johnson Claims MN-1 Victory by 323 Votes; Recount Possible After 19 NOV Canvass; Omar Celebrates

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| WHAT / WHERE / WHEN | Unofficial Secretary of State results show Democrat Jake Johnson ahead of Republican Rep. Brad Finstad by 323 votes, 49.99% to 49.89% (MPR; Star Tribune); KTTC reported 163,056 to 162,733. Johnson declared victory in Rochester on 04 NOV; AP has not called the race. The margin is under Minnesota’s 0.25% threshold for a publicly funded recount, which is not automatic: Finstad must request it within two business days after the State Canvassing Board certifies results on 19 NOV, that is, through 23 NOV (KTTC; Star Tribune; Mankato Free Press). Finstad’s campaign had not said whether it will seek one. University of Minnesota professor Larry Jacobs told MPR that leads “in the hundreds” usually stand. Blue Earth County estimated about two days of recount work there. Fox News showed Rep. Ilhan Omar celebrating her fifth term in Minneapolis. |
| US IMPACT ASSESSMENT | A Johnson win adds to the House majority and flips the seat last held by Democrats when Tim Walz represented it. The recount decision will not come until after 19 NOV. |
| SOURCE SYNOPSIS | MPR (05 NOV); Star Tribune (two articles, 04–05 NOV); KTTC (04 NOV); Mankato Free Press (all search excerpts); Fox News X post (04 NOV). |
| MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT) | Fox News focused on Omar’s “victory dance”; no right-leaning MN-1 coverage was found. |
| MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM) | MPR called it a “massive upset” in southern Minnesota tied to Johnson’s focus on costs and rural towns. |
| CONFIDENCE | HIGH on margin and recount rules (multiple outlets). Final result pending. |

**MN / US COST SNAPSHOT**

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| RESIDENTIAL ELECTRICITY (MN) | 17.20¢/kWh for August 2026 vs a US average of 18.16¢/kWh (EIA Electric Power Monthly Table 5.6.A, checked 05 NOV 26; no new month). |
| REGULAR GASOLINE (MN) | $3.9977/gal (AAA Minnesota, 05 NOV 26); yesterday $4.0279; week ago $4.1493; month ago $4.2065; year ago $2.9897. National AAA regular $4.1003, down from $4.1239 (AAA, 05 NOV 26). |
| DIESEL (MN) | $6.1183/gal (AAA Minnesota, 05 NOV 26); yesterday $6.1404; week ago $6.1949; month ago $6.1438; year ago $3.6882. National AAA diesel $6.2564, down from $6.2748 (AAA, 05 NOV 26). |
| GROUND BEEF (MN PROXY) | $7.253/lb for September 2026, all uncooked ground beef, Midwest Census Region urban (BLS via FRED APU0200FC1101; checked 05 NOV 26; no new month); August $7.317. Not Minnesota-specific. |
| GOLD SPOT | $4,115.70/troy oz (proxy feed gold-api.com XAU/USD, 1322 UTC / 0722 CST 05 NOV 26), up from $4,043.10 at 1314 UTC 04 NOV. Reuters reported gold rose 3.5% on 04 NOV, its best day since 19 AUG. Not Kitco/LBMA. |
| US NATIONAL DEBT | $40,547,403,570,984.82 total public debt outstanding (Treasury Debt to the Penny, record date 03 NOV 26), up about $45.3 billion from $40,502,080,966,097.14 on 02 NOV; debt held by the public $32,765,330,118,710.62 and intragovernmental holdings $7,782,073,452,274.20. |

## OPEN THREADS CARRIED FORWARD

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| Elections | Alaska (ranked-choice results 18 NOV; DOJ appeal of the dismissed certification suit) and Mississippi (county certification 13 NOV; no automatic recount); final House count; GOP leadership votes (Scalise vs. Jordan; Thune); lame-duck agenda and vetoes; Democratic oversight and war-powers/appropriations plans; DOJ monitor follow-up in Michigan; Ninth Circuit stay of the Thompson TRO; Carter hearing 13 NOV; NAACP FOIA production. |
| Iran | Qatari proposal feedback (36-hour window passed with no public result found); Oman joint Hormuz mechanism; strike decision and CENTCOM plans; Vance–Rezaei contact; Iranian threats to undersea cables; Chinese envoy visit; Pickaxe Mountain; Carlson nuclear claim (still unconfirmed). |
| Gulf shipping | 196-26 tanker identity and damage; 195-26 and 193-26 vessel identities; IRGC mine and fire claims; LUCAS and MQ-1 claims; Selat Storm crew status; Louise 1 attacker. |
| Pentagon | Hegseth's status; Cooper and Caine blame reports; J5 replacement for Sylvia; US death toll at 23 (no update found). |
| Israel | whether the $4 billion aid cutoff is formalized; Herzog's coalition consultations; Knesset swearing-in 10 NOV. |
| Saudi/Yemen | Riyadh airport damage claim; Medina-area missile; Taiz and Lahj fighting; US ordered departure. |
| Economy | October jobs report 06 NOV; jobless claims today; oil after its weekly drop; December FOMC; OPEC+ 29 NOV; DOE SPR exchange award (still not found). |
| Russia/Ukraine | White House Oleshky talks outcome; Abu Dhabi talks 10–11 NOV; Kyiv blackouts and water outages; Zaporizhzhia toll; possible Trump–Putin meeting at APEC. |
| Minnesota | MN-1 canvass 19 NOV and recount window to 23 NOV; final legislative seats; Klobuchar Senate seat appointment (no announcement found); Boasberg's Omar unsealing decision; O'Keefe/Higby first appearance 16 NOV; Good/Pretti evidence suit. |
| Palm Beach crash | NTSB preliminary report (no update found this period). |

## UNCONFIRMED / QUARANTINED

- IRGC claims of four tankers destroyed by mines, two vessels halted, two more tankers and a tug on fire, a further tanker mined east of the strait, two LUCAS drones captured intact, and a 15th MQ-1 shot down: Iranian sources only, no vessel names or US confirmation.
- Houthi claims of “extensive damage” at King Khalid International Airport and attacks in al-Jawf, Jizan, and Najran: unverified.
- Russian defense ministry claims of hitting a Nova Poshta terminal and a cargo ship carrying military equipment: not confirmed by Ukraine.
- Timcast News’s “43-point swing” among young white men without college degrees: source of the figure not seen.

**Carry-forward**

Tucker Carlson’s nuclear-strike claim; Iranian navy unnamed-tanker mine claim of 02 NOV; Yemeni government claim of about 500 Houthi fighters killed; Al-Araby Al-Jadeed “breakthrough” report (denied); Rezaei’s earlier claim the US “indicated its readiness” to accept Iran’s terms; Melania Trump “intermediary” report on Iran; Glenn Beck’s HSI Omar memo; Bessent’s reported $1 billion Iran-linked crypto; DHS “large case” report on Omar; Palm Beach flight-path rumors; Michael Knowles’s Flanagan t-shirt characterization.

## GAPS AND NOTES

- The Israel aid item happened on 03 NOV, just before this period, and is included because the 04 NOV report missed it; aid figures and the 2028/2027 timelines come from search summaries, not full articles.
- CBS’s Iran and election live pages, Al Jazeera (Alaska/Mississippi, Ukraine), CNBC (oil), and UPI were read directly; most other items are from search excerpts and headlines. AP pages timed out.
- Gold is from a proxy feed, not Kitco/LBMA. EIA electricity (August 2026) and BLS beef (September 2026) have no new month. The EIA weekly crude figure is from a search summary.

**Right-leaning coverage**

X feeds of TheBlaze, Glenn Beck, Daily Wire, Matt Walsh, Michael Knowles, Ben Shapiro, Tim Pool/Timcast News, Steven Crowder, S2 Underground, and Fox News were searched from 1330 UTC 04 NOV. Found: Fox News on Vance, Trump, Schumer, GOP leadership, and Omar; TheBlaze on Thune, DeSantis, Talarico, and markets; Daily Wire clips of Trump on Hegseth, impeachment, and Vance; Walsh on the economy and investigations; Tim Pool on Fuentes and “MAGA is OVER”; Crowder on “woke 2.0”; Beck with Steve Deace. No S2 Underground posts matched, and no right-leaning coverage of the Iran statements, ship attacks, Yemen, Ukraine, or MN-1 was found.

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